Unleashing Your Leadership Potential

Becoming an Impactful Leader

THE SHIFT: WHAT WE WILL ACHIEVE

- Understand what actually changes when moving from expert to leader.
- Identify leadership patterns that help or limit impact.
- Practice concrete behaviors that increase influence and ownership.
- Leave with one leadership experiment to apply immediately.

HOW WE WORK

- Cameras on.
- Speak from experience.
- Concrete actions, not “insights”.

Objectives: The Shift to Impact

By the end of this module, you will navigate the transition from “High Performer” to “Leader” by mastering four key dimensions.

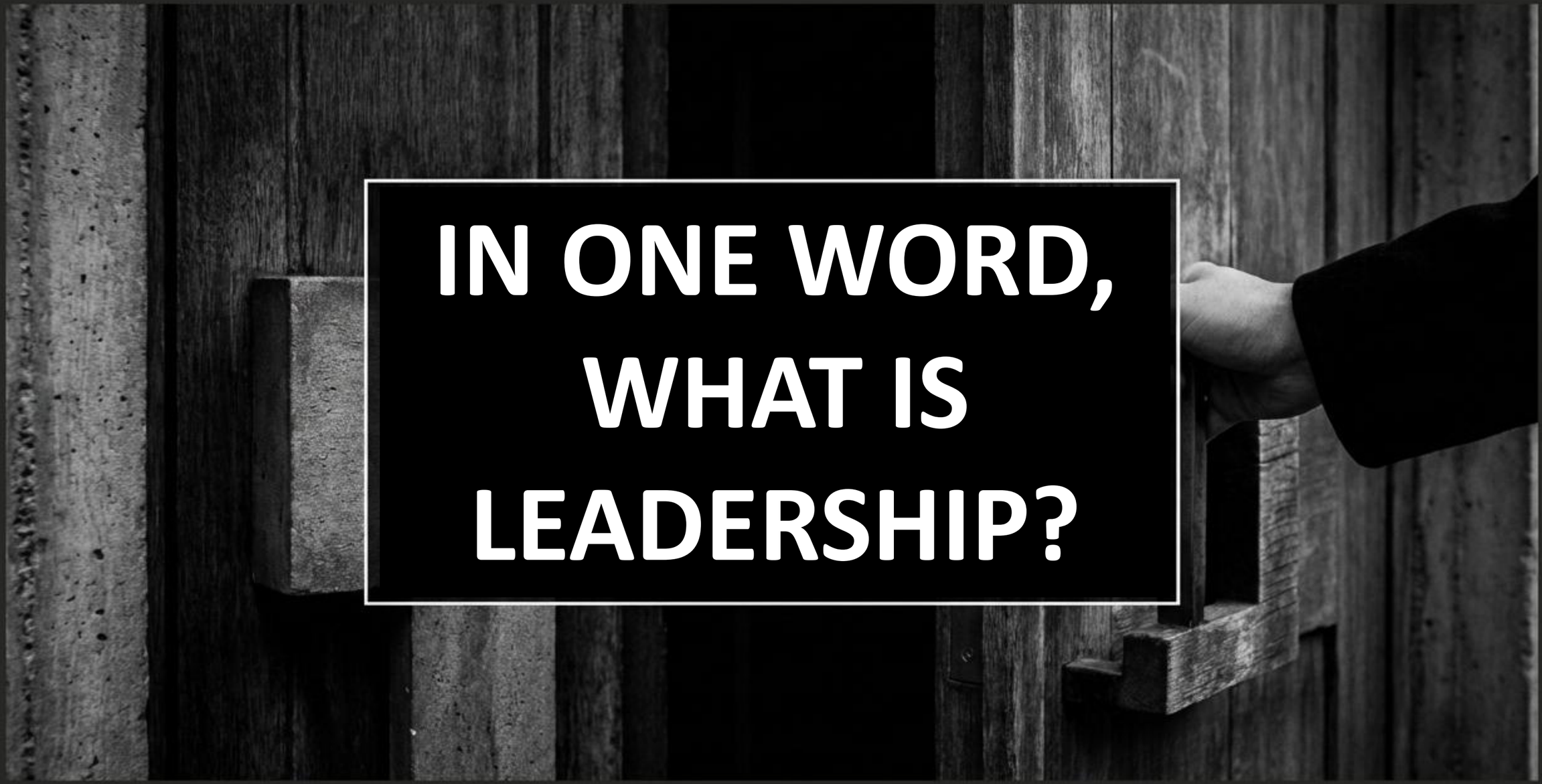
01 / THE SHIFT
Understanding what actually changes in your daily mechanics.

02 / BARRIERS
Identifying patterns that limit your impact.

03 / INFLUENCE
Practicing concrete behaviors that drive ownership.

04 / RESULTS
Leaving with a specific leadership experiment to apply immediately.

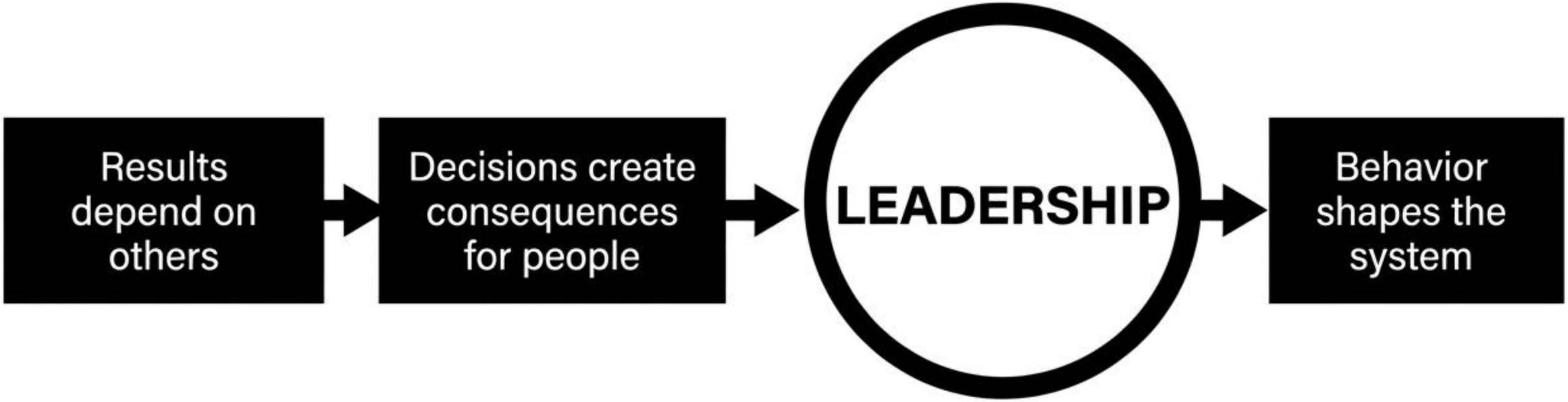
HOW WE WORK: Practical frameworks, honest reflection, and concrete actions—not just “insights.”



IN ONE WORD, WHAT IS LEADERSHIP?

Leadership Is Not a Promotion

High performance ≠ Leadership impact.



Key Concept: Leadership is responsibility for impact, not a position

LEADERSHIP IS NOT A PROMOTION

IF YOU DECIDE TO LOOK OUT FOR THE PERSON ON THE LEFT OF YOU, TO THE PERSON ON THE RIGHT OF YOU, YOU HAVE BECOME A LEADER

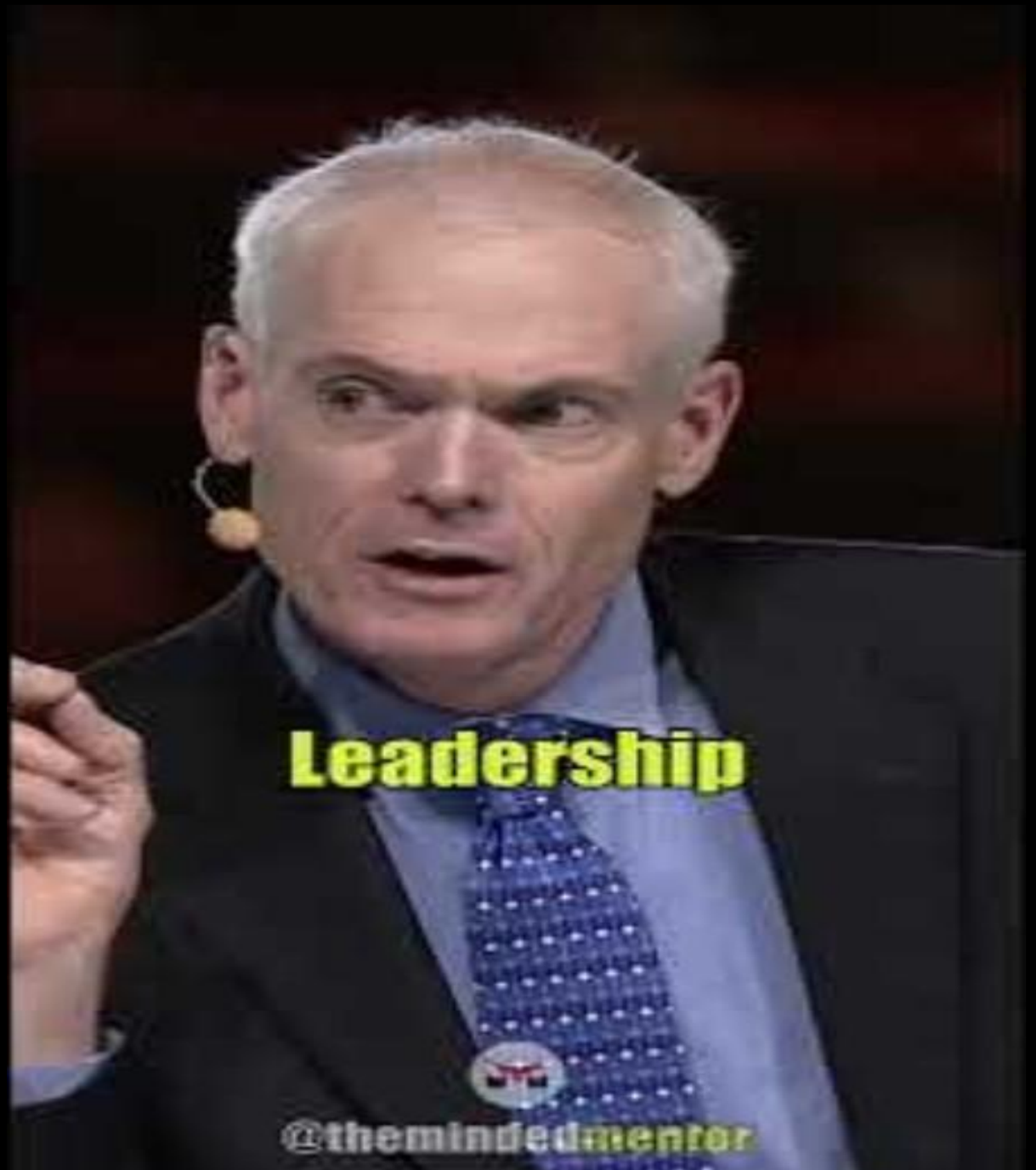
LEADERSHIP IS A DECISION, LEADERSHIP IS A CHOICE
Simon Sinek

https://www.youtube.com/shorts/_U2JPomyM-4?feature=share

Leadership only exists if people follow when they would have the freedom to not follow.
Otherwise, it’s just power. And Power is not Leadership.

Jim Collins

https://www.youtube.com/shorts/C9vsSmgfmnM



A Moment I Felt Like a Leader

Think of a specific moment where you influenced people or outcomes without relying on formal authority.

What happened? | What did you actually do?

THE REAL SHIFT

INDIVIDUAL CONTRIBUTOR	LEADER
Solves problems	Defines problems
Delivers results	Creates conditions
Controls quality	Builds ownership
Is rewarded for expertise	Is accountable for outcomes

EVIDENCE & MECHANISMS OF FIRST-TIME LEADER EFFECTIVENESS

MOVING FROM ‘STYLE’ TO ‘REPEATABLE SYSTEMS’

THE MYTH

~~Leadership Style~~

~~Charisma~~

~~Personality~~

THE EVIDENCE (2020-2024)

Repeatable Mechanisms

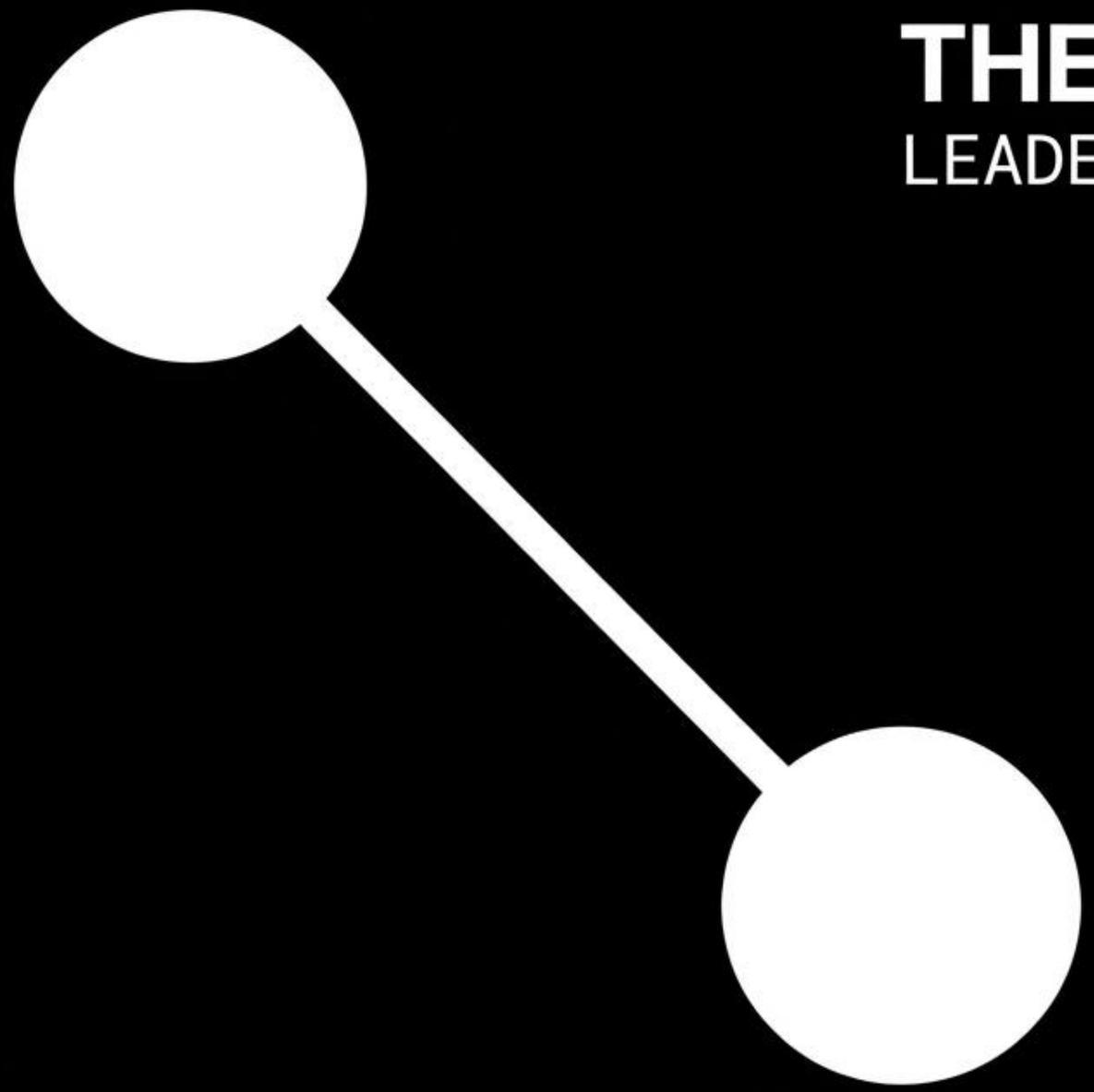
Behavioral Routines

Systematic Design

SHIFT: FROM WHO YOU ARE (IDENTITY) TO WHAT YOU DO (ROUTINE).

THE CORE ENGINE: LMX

LEADER-MEMBER EXCHANGE



Relationship quality is the single most robust predictor of retention and performance.

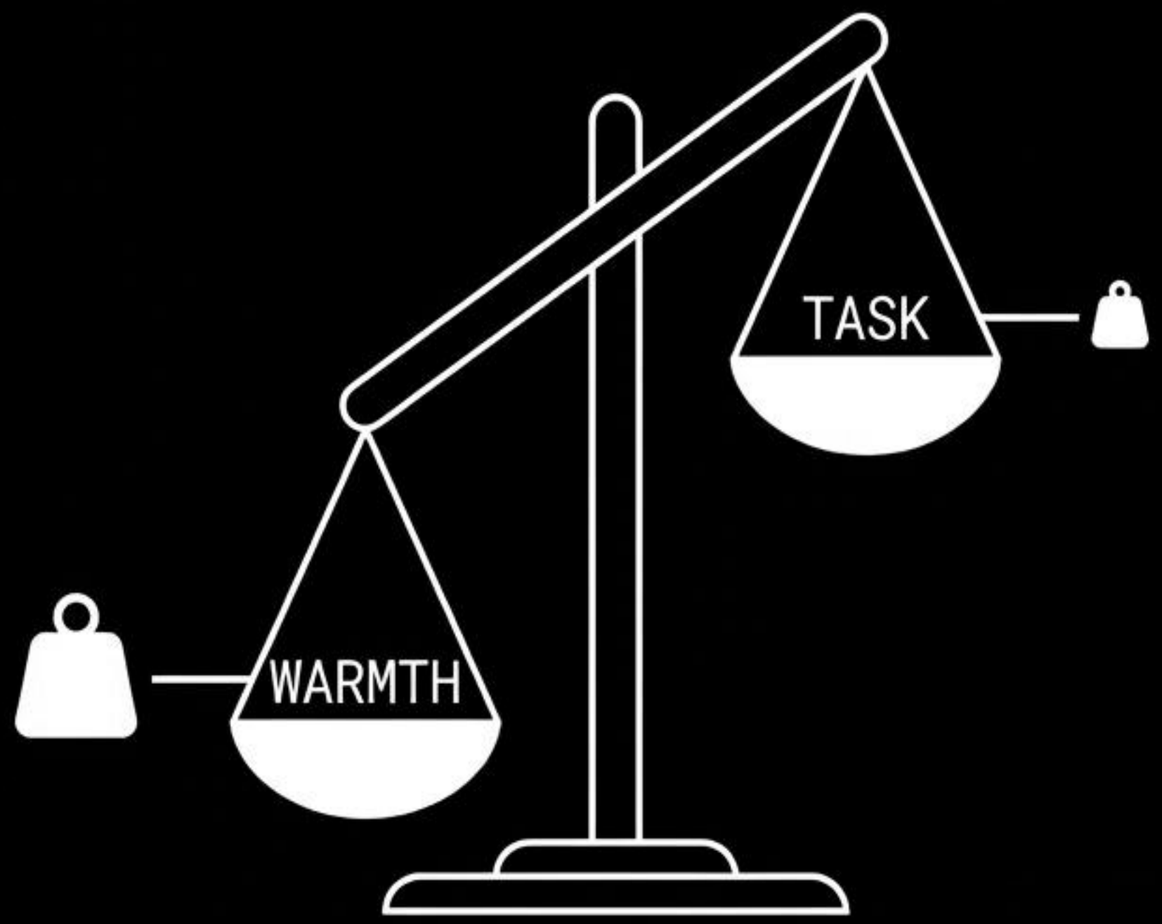
CRITICAL NUANCE:
It is not about friendship.
It is about **ALIGNMENT & AGREEMENT**
Risk Factor = Misalignment between leader perception and employee reality.

WHY NEW LEADERS FAIL.

THE HIDDEN DRIVERS OF EARLY FAILURE

Even with high intent, new leaders fall into structural traps. These are not failures of character. These are friction points in the transition system.

TRAP 1: THE LIKABILITY OVER-CORRECTION



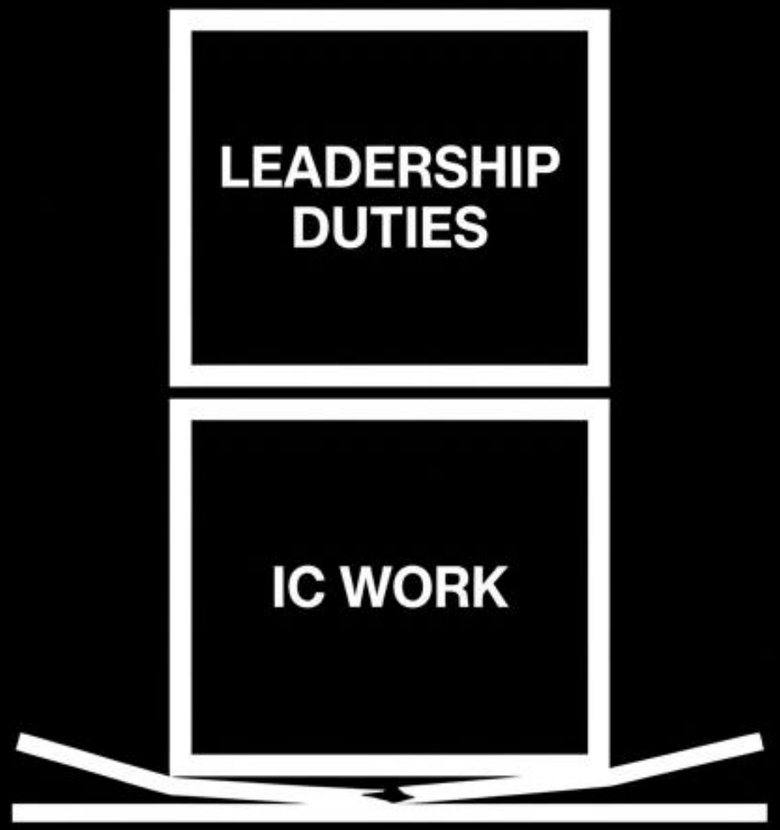
Mechanism:
Over-correcting into relationship behaviors to 'win' the team.

Evidence (Leadership Quarterly, 2024):
Large shifts toward warmth reduce follower-perceived effectiveness. Sudden identity swings signal inauthenticity and loss of task focus.

IT'S NOT ABOUT BEING LIKED

Coach Carter Video
https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=V1wAemvxNaM

TRAP 2: THE INDIVIDUAL CONTRIBUTOR HANGOVER

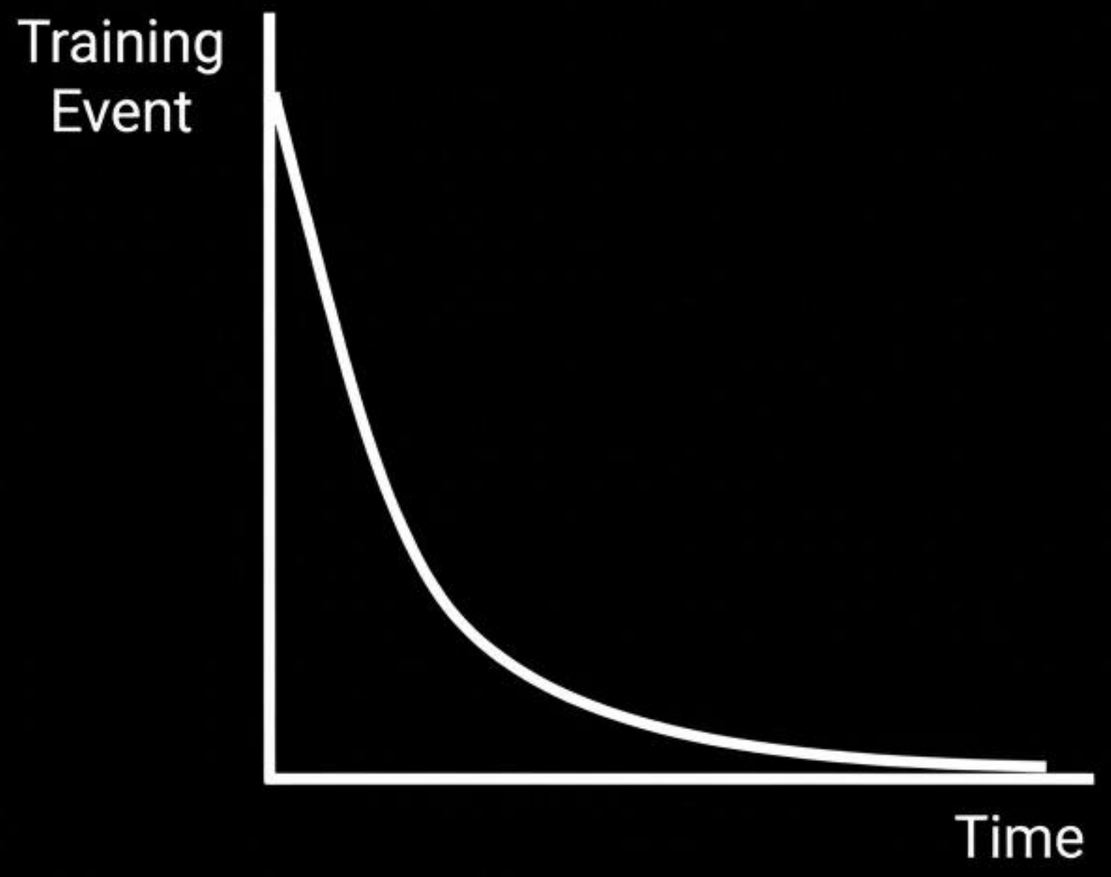


Mechanism: "I'll just keep doing the work myself."

The Cycle:

1. Retaining IC work + Adding Leadership
2. Role Overload + Role Overload + Role Ambiguity
3. Result: Strain, Burnout, and Bottlenecks.

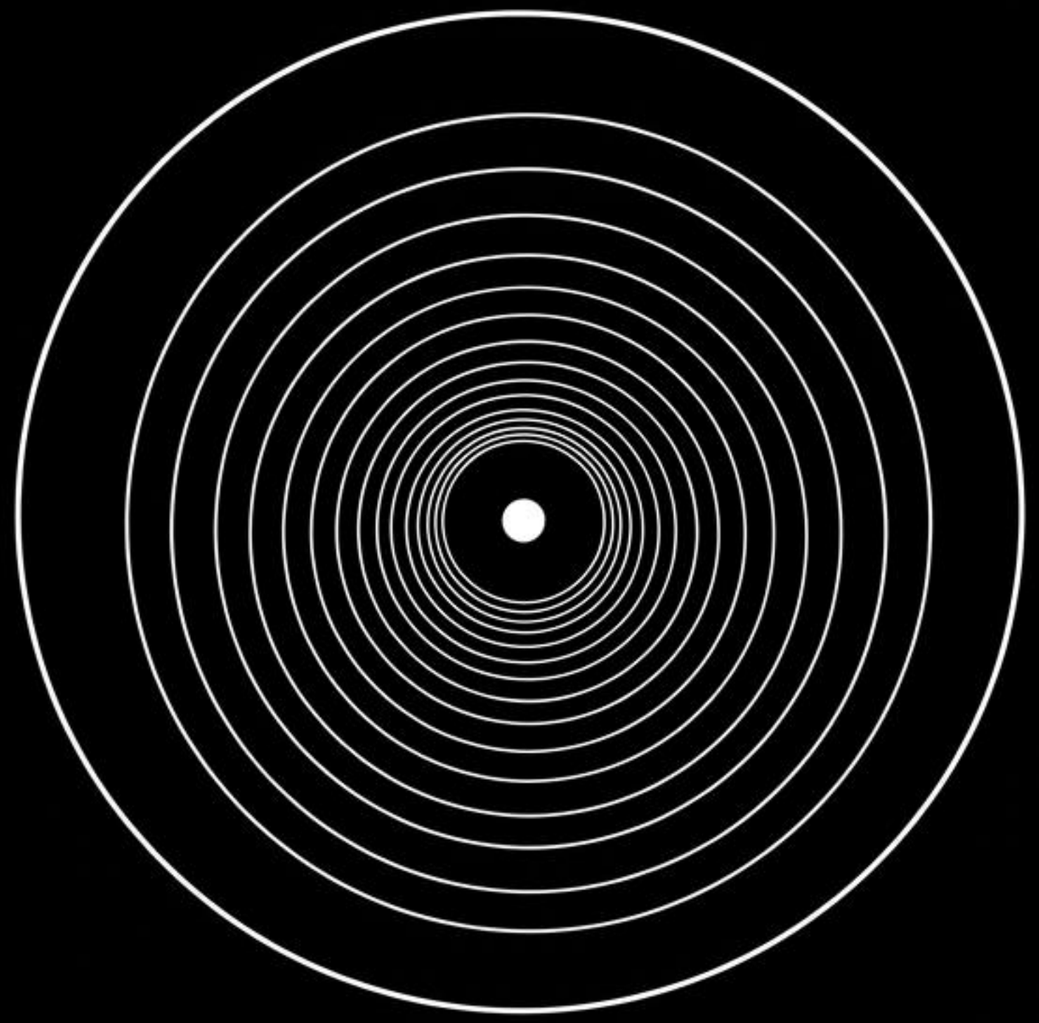
TRAP 3: THE TRANSFER GAP



Mechanism: "I learned it, but I don't do it."

The Evidence: Implementation is the Achilles heel of training. Without just-in-time nudges, training effects decay immediately. New managers fail to build the weekly routines required for behavior change.

TRAP 4: THE DRIFT INTO CONTROL



Mechanism: Micromanagement as a stress response.

The Insight: Pressure reveals exaggerated strengths.
Decisive → Becomes Controlling.
Helpful → Becomes Interfering.
Analytical → Becomes Paralyzing.
Result: Erosion of team ownership.

Barriers & Traps for New Leaders

Doing instead of leading.
(Falling back on execution)

Jumping in too fast.
(Solving before defining)

Avoiding authority.
(Trying to stay "liked")

Becoming the bottleneck.
(Centralizing decisions)

These are not weaknesses—they are overused strengths.

PERSONAL LEADERSHIP SHIFT MAP

INDIVIDUAL REFLECTION (5 MIN)

Answer honestly:

— Where do I still operate as an individual contributor?

— Where do I step in too fast?

— What decisions or issues tend to come back to me?

Courage Under Pressure

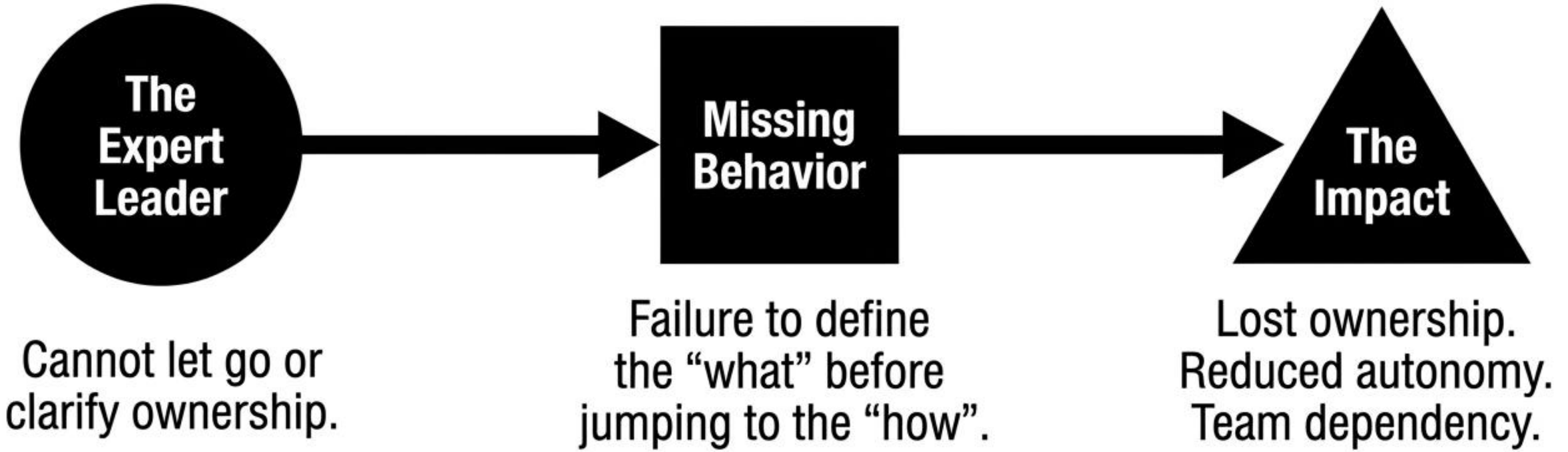
What Shows Up When Things Get Hard?

Decisive → PRESSURE → **Controlling**

Helpful → PRESSURE → **Interfering**

Analytical → PRESSURE → **Paralyzing**

The Cost of the “Expert” Mindset



REFLECTION: Where do you see this pattern in your own work?

Taking Care of Others

Moving from “Fixing” to “Coaching”.

> When you solve their problem, you steal their growth.

The Mechanism

- Listen to Reflect (Don’t just listen to solve)
- Reflect, Don’t Fix

Coaching Pair Prompt

- What triggers the urge to jump in?
- What would “10% less” intervention look like?

Strengths & Limits Diagnosis

IDENTIFY

2 Leadership strengths you rely on.

IDENTIFY

2 Patterns that may limit you under pressure.

IDENTIFY

1 Leadership habit you want to experiment with.

COACHING PAIRS

10% LESS

- BREAKOUT PAIRS (10 MIN) – SWITCH HALFWAY
- PERSON A: Shares one strength & one overused pattern.
  PERSON B (THE COACH) ASKS:
  - What triggers this pattern?
  - What would ‘10% less’ look like?
  - What is one small experiment you can try?

DIAGNOSIS DEBRIEF

WHAT WAS HARD TO ADMIT?
WHAT FELT ACTIONABLE?

LEADERSHIP IS VISIBLE IN SMALL MOMENTS

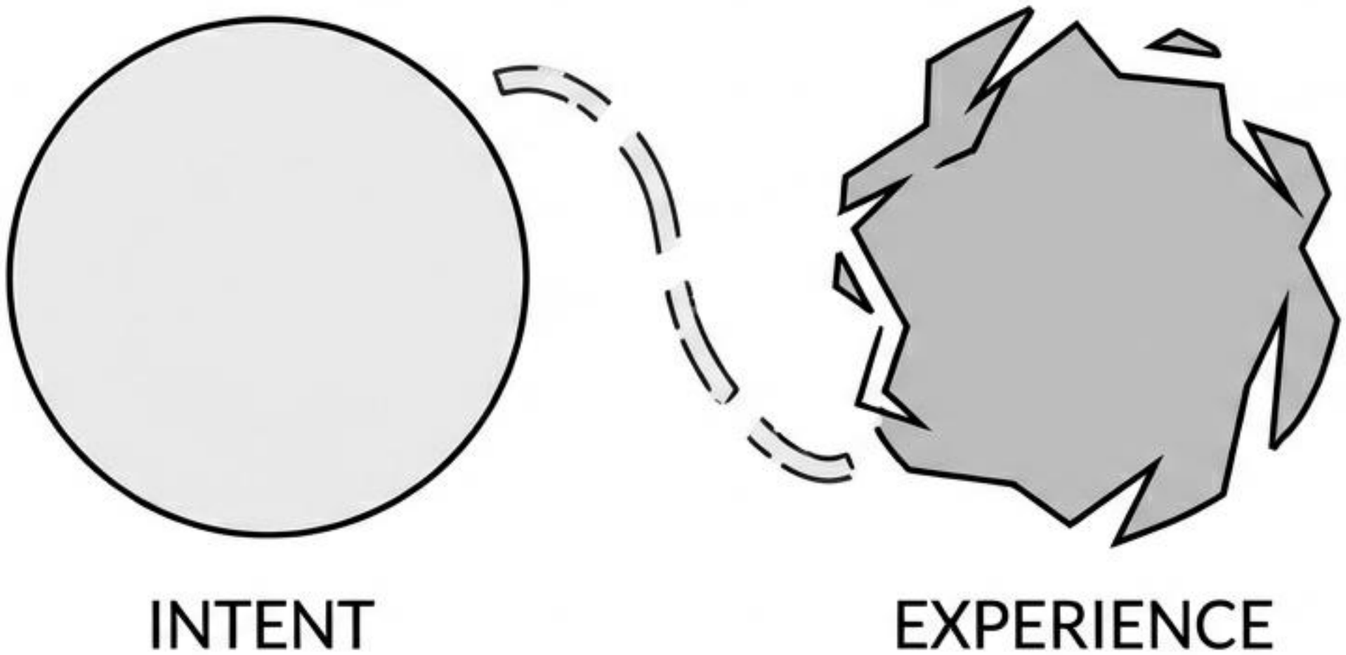
// How meetings end.

// How decisions are framed.

// How uncertainty is named.

// What gets followed up —
and what doesn't.

THE GAP BETWEEN INTENT AND EXPERIENCE



People don’t experience your intent. They experience your patterns.

Predictability builds trust more than charisma.

CREDIBILITY = CONSISTENCY UNDER PRESSURE

COMMITMENT TO ACTION

BETWEEN NOW AND NEXT SESSION

THE LEADERSHIP EXPERIMENT

1. Pick one real situation.
2. Try one different behavior.
3. Observe the impact.

DON’T TRY TO BE BETTER.
TRY TO BE MORE DELIBERATE.

The Science of Leading by Example

How Modeling the Way Drives Psychological Ownership, Trust, and Organizational Performance

Leadership by Example is a Strategic Resource.

It is not just a moral imperative; it is a value-creation driver.

The Core Argument

Leading by Example (LBE) is a mechanism that triggers a specific psychological chain reaction. Research indicates that the impact of LBE on productivity is amplified when combined with strong organizational core values.

The Catalyst: Leading by Doing

Operationalizing the behavior of the leader.

Definition: Leading by Example (LBE) is the practical manifestation of commitment. It includes behaviors such as working as hard as one can and working harder than team members.

The Golden Rule: The more often you display these behaviors, the better leader you'll be.

Clarify Values

- Find your voice
- Affirm shared values

Set the Example

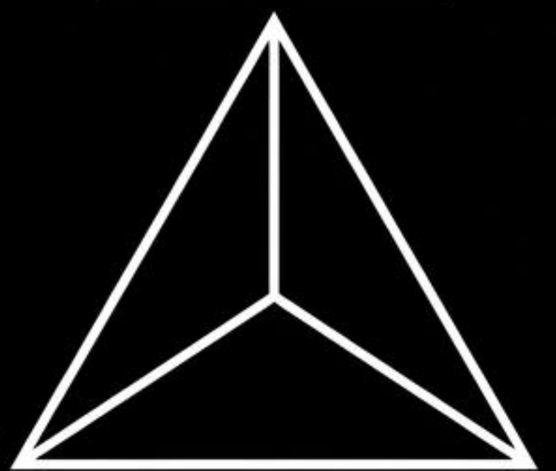
- Align actions with values
- Follow through on promises

Engage

- Build consensus
- Ask for feedback on performance impact

Influence Without Authority

CLARITY
(Who decides what?)



CONSISTENCY
(Same message, same behavior)

OWNERSHIP
(Closing loops)

Micro-Behaviors

- Naming decisions explicitly.
- Assigning ownership out loud.

Core Concept: Moving from "Do this because I said so" to "Do this because the objective requires it."

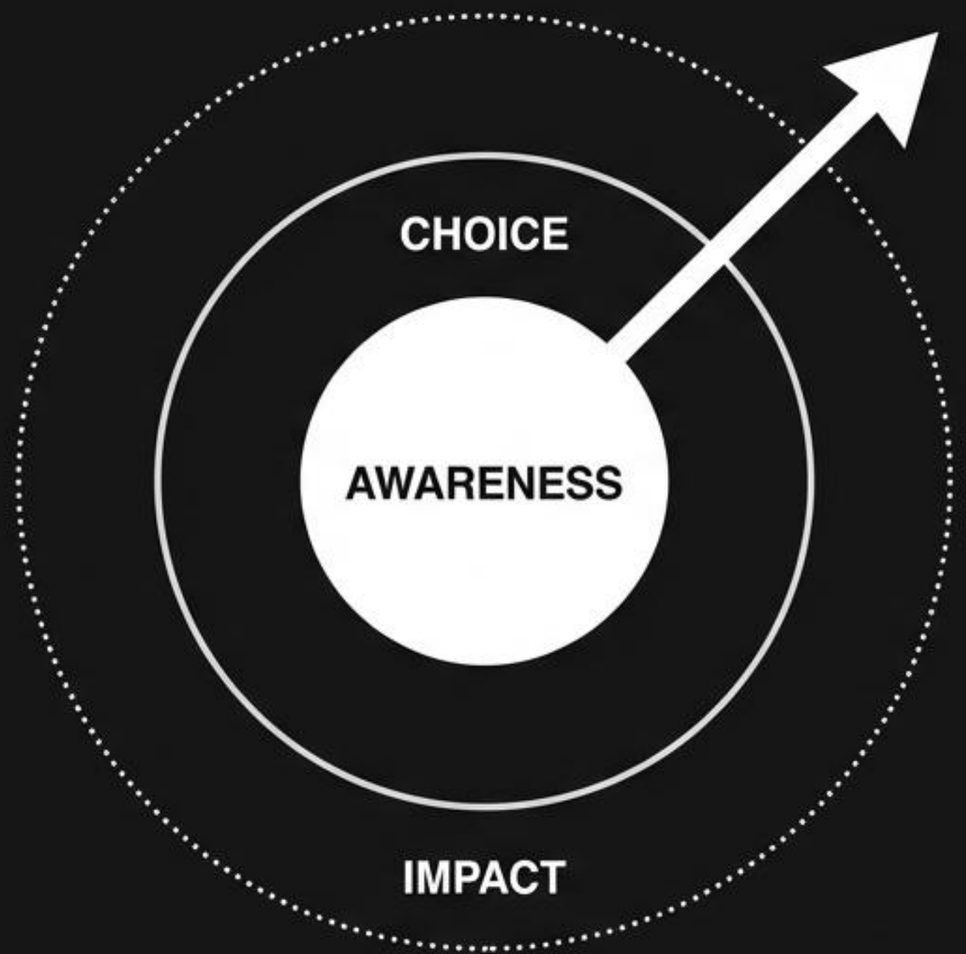
Inspiration is Visible in Small Moments

How meetings end.

How decisions are framed.

How uncertainty is named.

What gets followed up.

Predictability builds trust more than charisma.

Leadership is an Inside-Out Discipline